

CHEAT-GM - GM Rules Reference

GM goal

Find any rule fast without leaving Run Mode.

GM notes

- Roll in 10 Seconds: Use this when a player asks what to roll.
- ? Pick the trait that matches the approach.
- ? Set the Difficulty before the roll matters.
- ? State the stakes.
- ? Roll Hope d12 + Fear d12.
- ? Add trait, Experience, and bonuses.
- ? Compare total to Difficulty.
- Action Roll Results: Read total first, then Hope/Fear spin.
- ? Critical Success: best outcome, gain Hope, clear 1 Stress.
- ? Success with Hope: they get it and gain Hope.
- ? Success with Fear: they get it, but cost or pressure enters.
- ? Failure with Hope: they miss, but gain Hope and a useful thread.
- ? Failure with Fear: they miss and the GM makes a stronger move.
- Difficulty Ladder: Beginner hinges often sit around 10-14.
- ? Very Easy 5.
- ? Easy 10.
- ? Average 15.
- ? Hard 20.
- ? Very Hard 25.
- ? Nearly Impossible 30.
- Six Traits: Translate the fictional approach, not the D&D skill name.
- ? Agility: sprint, leap, maneuver.
- ? Strength: lift, smash, grapple.
- ? Finesse: control, hide, tinker.
- ? Instinct: perceive, sense, navigate.
- ? Presence: charm, perform, deceive.
- ? Knowledge: recall, analyze, comprehend.
- D&D to Daggerheart: Convert the instinct quickly, then move on.
- ? Perception -> Instinct.
- ? Saving throw/save -> Reaction Roll.
- ? AC -> Evasion.
- ? Initiative -> Spotlight flow.
- ? Skill check -> Action Roll.
- Hope Spend Menu: Give players fast ways to help themselves and each other.
- ? Help an Ally.
- ? Use an Experience.
- ? Tag Team Roll.
- ? Use a Hope Feature.
- Fear Spend Menu: Spend Fear to escalate what the fiction already set up.
- ? Make or interrupt with a GM move.

- ? Make an extra move when pressure justifies it.
- ? Spotlight an additional adversary.
- ? Use an adversary or environment Fear feature.
- ? Add an adversary Experience when the stat block supports it.
- Combat / Spotlight Loop: No initiative list; pass spotlight through the fiction.
- ? Spotlight follows immediate fictional pressure.
- ? PC action roll targets adversary Difficulty.
- ? Adversary attack: d20 + ATK vs PC Evasion.
- ? GM acts on failures, rolls with Fear, and Fear spends.
- Damage / Armor / Stress: Compare damage to thresholds; do not improvise a condition.
- ? Compare damage to the target's thresholds.
- ? Mark HP by damage severity.
- ? Mark an Armor Slot to reduce severity by one threshold.
- ? If Stress maxes, the PC becomes Vulnerable until at least 1 Stress clears.
- ? Last HP points to the Death Move / quickstart handling.
- Official Conditions: Only these global conditions belong in the Atlas.
- ? Hidden.
- ? Restrained.
- ? Vulnerable.
- Short Rest: Use before Open Vale pressure spikes.
- ? GM gains 1d4 Fear.
- ? Tend to Wounds.
- ? Clear Stress.
- ? Repair Armor.
- ? Prepare.
- ? Long rest is true downtime: GM gains PC count + 1d4 Fear and can advance a long-term countdown.
- Countdown: Make pressure visible and explain what a tick means.
- ? Name what the countdown represents.
- ? Tick it when the fiction or result calls for pressure.
- ? Use the Open Vale ritual countdown as module pressure, not a condition.
- Beginner Teaching Script: Keep the explanation short enough to resume play.
- ? Two d12s: Hope and Fear.
- ? The total decides success against Difficulty.
- ? The higher die decides whether Hope or Fear colors the result.
- ? Traits replace D&D skills.
- ? Damage compares to thresholds; Armor can reduce severity.
- ? There is no initiative order; spotlight follows the fiction.
- GM Screen Edge Cases: Fast handles for rules that come up mid-session but do not deserve a lecture.
- ? Group Action: choose a leader; helpers roll reactions; successes and failures shift the leader's roll.
- ? Fate Roll: define the stakes, then roll one Duality Die when the outcome is pure chance.
- ? Temporary effects: clear through the listed move, natural end, or GM/Fear procedure if a spell says so.
- ? Falling or collision: use the SRD damage guide and fit the danger to the fiction.
- ? Spellcast Roll: only when a feature calls for the character's Spellcast trait.

- ? Unarmed attack: Strength or Finesse, then Proficiency d4 damage on a hit.

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